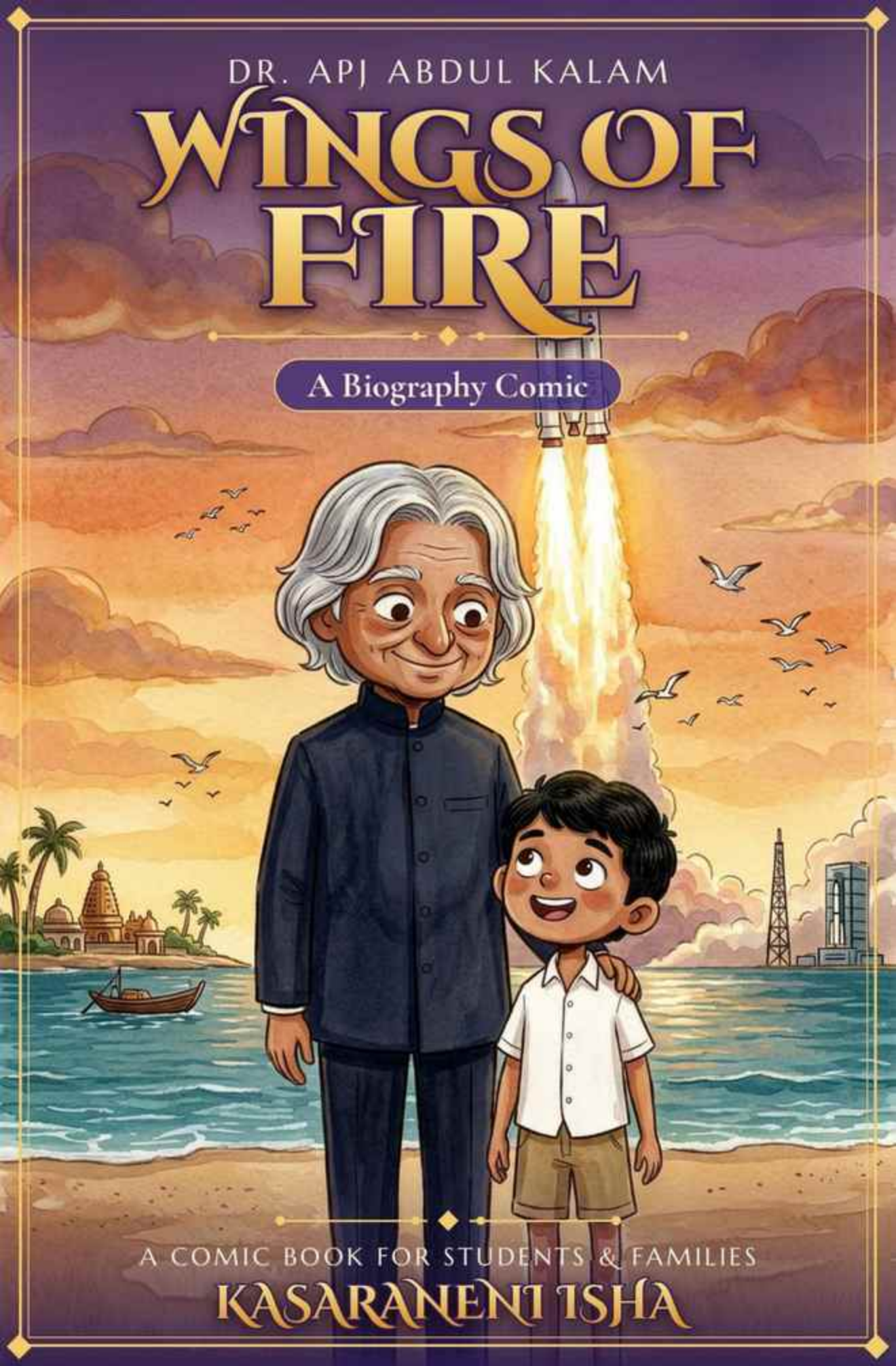
DR. APJ ABDUL KALAM

WINGS OF FIRE

A Biography Comic



A COMIC BOOK FOR STUDENTS & FAMILIES

KASARANENI ISHA

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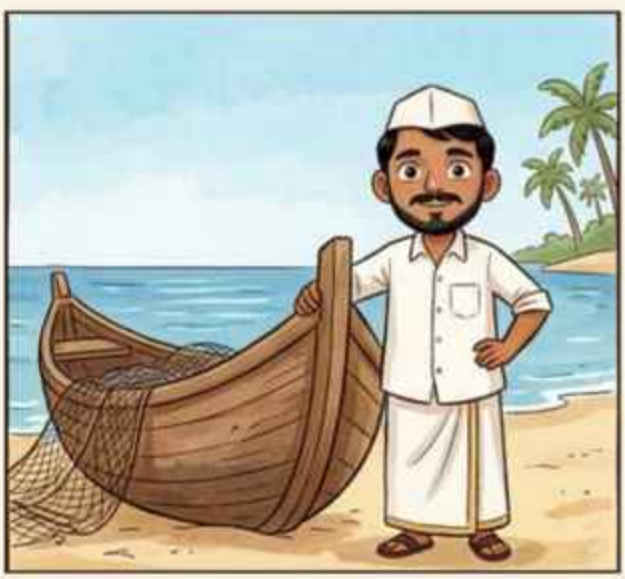
A BOY NAMED ABDUL KALAM



On 15 October 1931, Avul Pakir Jainulabiddin Abdul Kalam was born in Rameswaram, Tamil Nadu.



He belonged to a humble family.
Mother: "Our little one has arrived!"



His father, Jainulabiddin Marakaya, was a boat owner, and his mother, Ashiamma Jainulabiddin, was a loving homemaker.



Although his family had limited money, they gave him love, discipline and strong values.
Father: "Always be honest, my son."

THE ISLAND OF INSPIRATION



Kalam grew up in the beautiful coastal town of Rameswaram.



He loved watching birds fly across the sky.
Kalam: "How do they fly so freely?"



His father taught him honesty, simplicity and kindness.



These childhood experiences planted the first seeds of his scientific dreams.
Kalam: "One day, I will fly too!"

A YOUNG NEWSPAPER SELLER



During his childhood, Kalam's family faced financial difficulties.



To support his family, he began distributing newspapers at a young age.
Kalam: "I can help my family!"

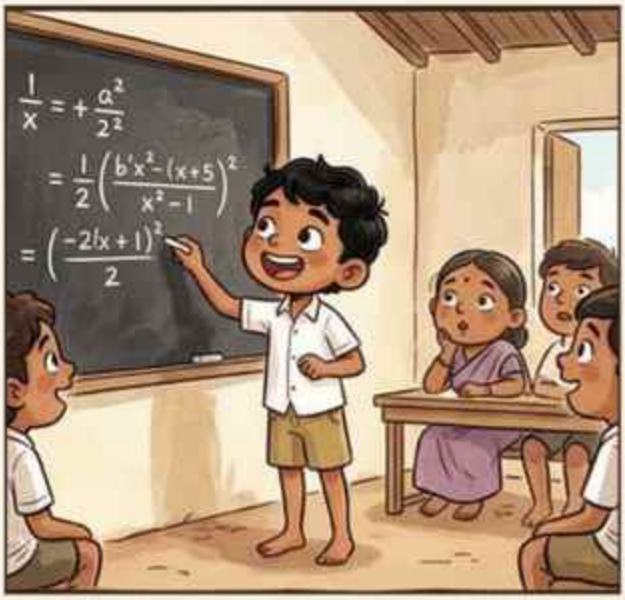


He woke up early every morning and finished his work...

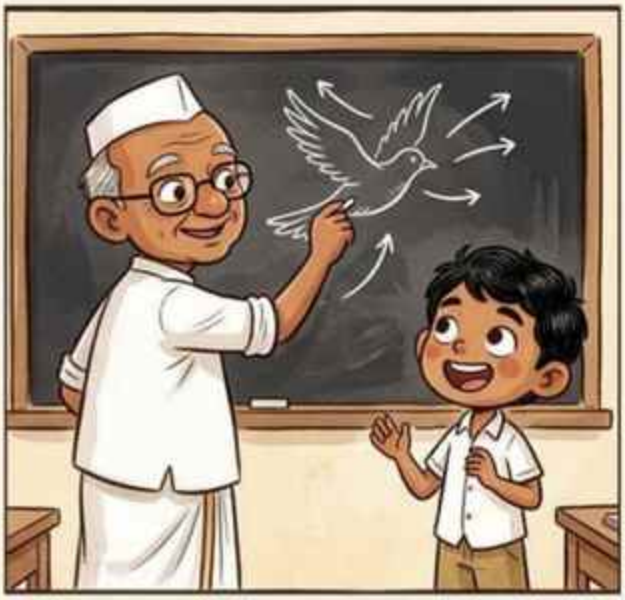


...and then attended school. Despite his responsibilities, he stayed dedicated to his education.

TEACHERS WHO CHANGED HIS LIFE



Kalam was a hardworking student who loved mathematics and science.



His teacher Sivasubramania Iyer introduced him to the science of flight.

Teacher: "See how the wings lift the bird?"



He encouraged Kalam to think differently.

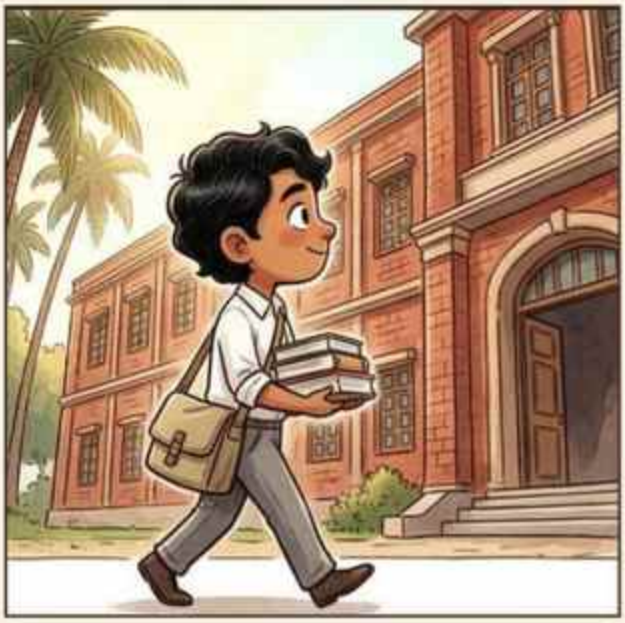
Kalam: "Now I understand!"



Another teacher, Iyadurai Solomon, taught him confidence, determination and belief in oneself.

Teacher: "Believe in yourself, Kalam!"

LEARNING BEYOND BOUNDARIES



Kalam completed his schooling at Schwartz Higher Secondary School in Ramanathapuram.



He later joined St. Joseph's College in Tiruchirappalli.



There he studied physics and graduated in 1954.



His interest in science kept growing as he explored the mysteries of the universe.

Kalam: "The universe is full of wonders!"

THE DREAM OF FLYING



Kalam joined the Madras Institute of Technology to study aerospace engineering.



He worked hard on aircraft design projects and learned about aerodynamics.



He dreamed of becoming an Air Force pilot but narrowly missed selection.
Kalam: "My dream... is gone?"



Instead of giving up, he decided to serve India's aviation and science.
Kalam: "I will serve my country another way!"

HIS FIRST SCIENTIFIC CAREER



In 1958, Kalam joined the Aeronautical Development Establishment under DRDO.



He began working on engineering and aviation projects.



One of his early assignments was designing a small hovercraft.
Kalam: "Let's make it float!"



This taught him the real challenges of scientific research.

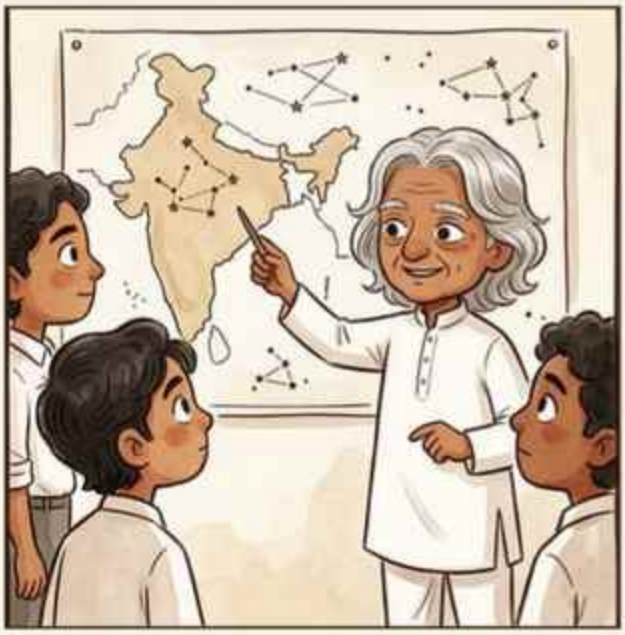
A NEW OPPORTUNITY



In 1962, Kalam became part of India's early space research through INCOSPAR.

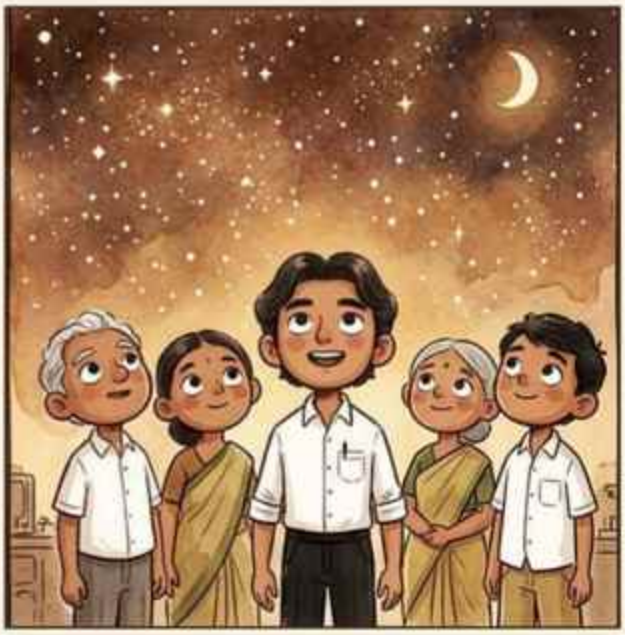


He joined scientists who dreamed of India's own space technology.



Under the vision of Dr. Vikram Sarabhai, India began its first steps toward space.

Dr. Sarabhai: "India must reach the stars!"



A new dream had begun.

A SMALL BEGINNING, A BIG DREAM



India's space programme began with limited resources but great ambition.

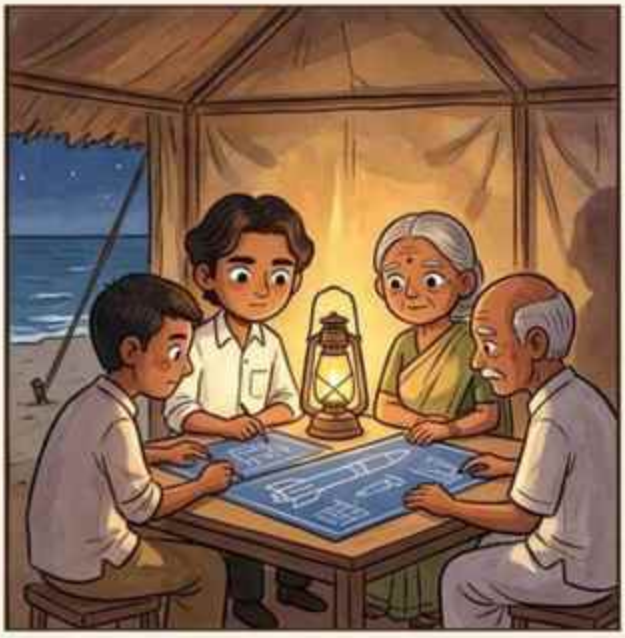


Scientists set up the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launching Station in Kerala.



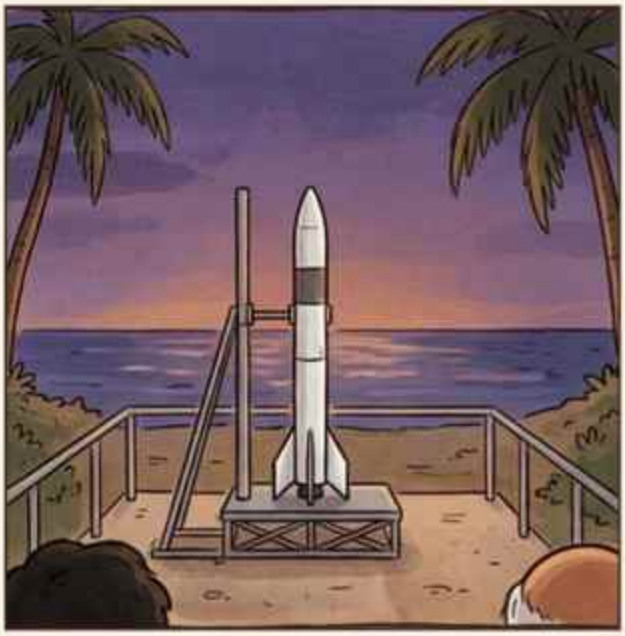
Kalam joined the early team working on rocket technology.

Kalam: "Careful, team!"

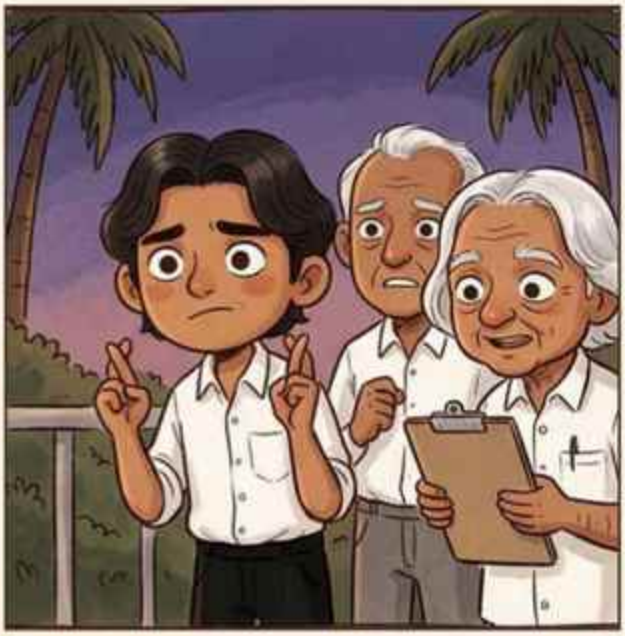


Their mission was to build India's scientific strength.

INDIA'S FIRST ROCKET LAUNCH



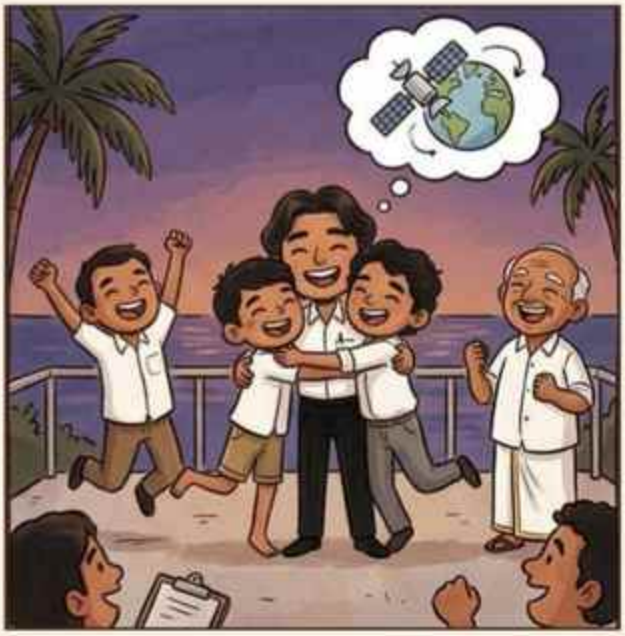
On 21 November 1963, India launched its first sounding rocket, a Nike-Apache, from Thumba.



Team: "3... 2... 1..."



It was an important milestone in Indian space research.
Team: "Hurray!"

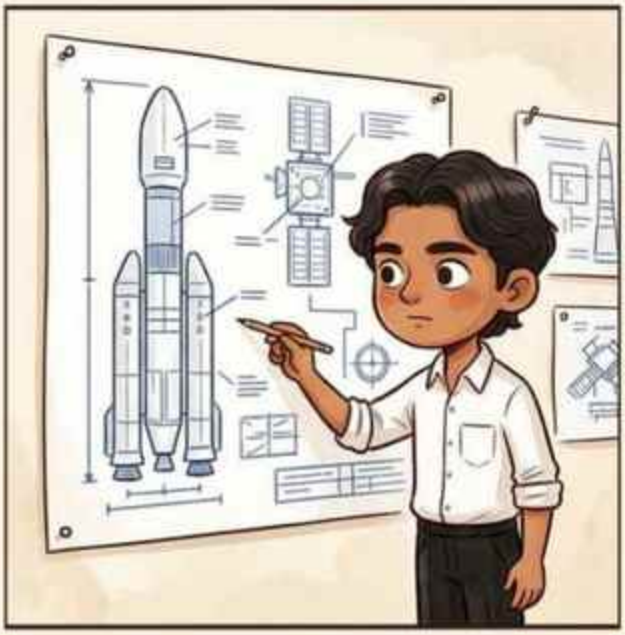


The success inspired them to build India's own rockets and satellites.

A NEW CHAPTER AT ISRO



In 1969, Kalam joined the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO).



He worked on India's Satellite Launch Vehicle programme.



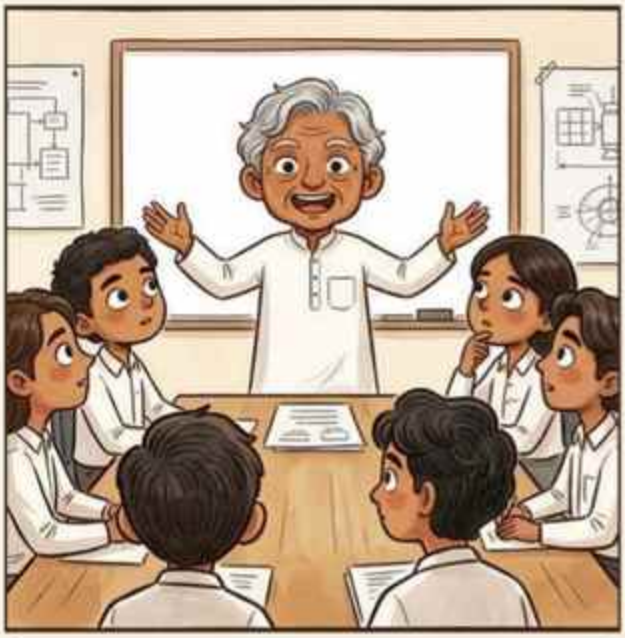
He worked with talented scientists and engineers.



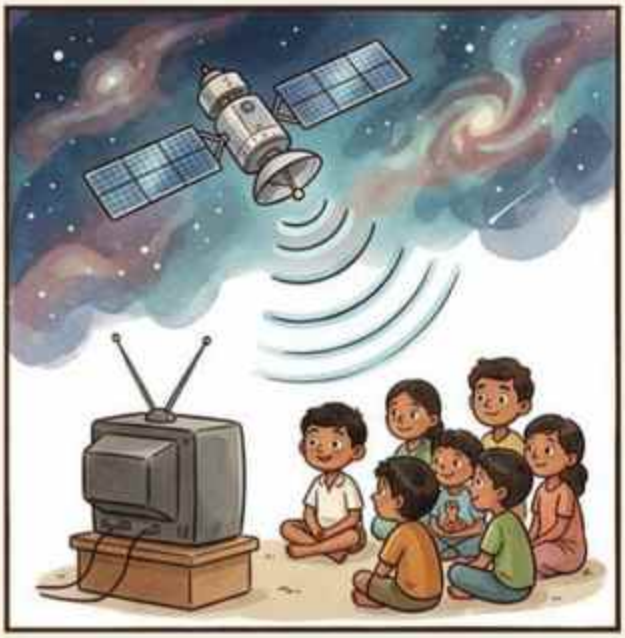
They wanted India to become self-reliant in space.

Kalam: "We will build it ourselves!"

THE VISION OF VIKRAM SARABHAI



Dr. Sarabhai: "Space technology must help ordinary people!"



He believed space technology could help through communication and education,



weather forecasting and national development.



Kalam was inspired. He understood that space could transform India's future.

BUILDING INDIA'S OWN ROCKET



Kalam was appointed Project Director of SLV-III.
Team: "Congratulations, sir!"



The mission: an Indian rocket that could put a satellite into low Earth orbit.



Scientists designed the rocket's stages...



...and developed its propulsion and guidance systems.

CHALLENGES BEHIND THE ROCKET



Developing SLV-III was very difficult.



The team faced problems with engines, structures, guidance and stage separation.



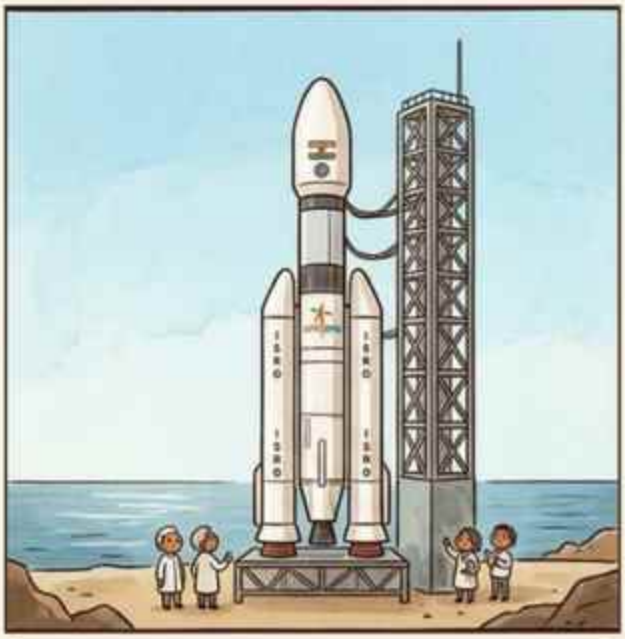
Every component needed careful testing.



Kalam kept his team united and committed.

Kalam: "Together, we will succeed!"

THE UNSUCCESSFUL LAUNCH



On 10 August 1979, India's first experimental SLV-3 launch took place at Sriharikota.



The rocket lifted off...
Team: "It's flying!"



...but a control problem stopped it from placing the Rohini satellite into orbit.



The scientists were heartbroken. Kalam felt deeply responsible.
Kalam: "It was my responsibility..."

THE POWER OF LEADERSHIP



ISRO Chairman Professor Satish Dhawan faced the media himself.



Prof. Dhawan: "I take responsibility. My team did their best."



He supported Kalam and his team instead of blaming them.
Prof. Dhawan: "We will try again."



Kalam learned that great leaders stand with their teams in failure.

PREPARING FOR SUCCESS



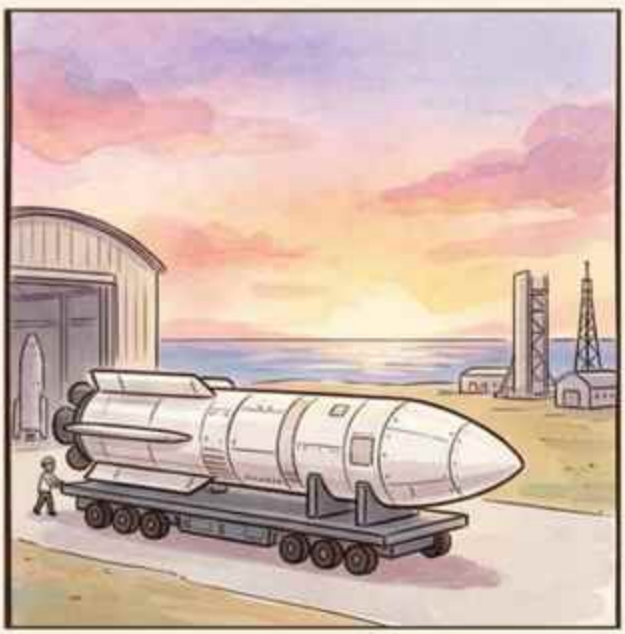
The team carefully studied the earlier failure.



They improved the rocket systems and tested again and again.



Kalam kept everyone confident.
Kalam: "We are ready this time!"



After months of hard work, they were ready to try again.

INDIA REACHES SPACE



On 18 July 1980, SLV-3 lifted off again.
Team: "Go! Go! Go!"



It placed the Rohini RS-1 satellite into orbit!

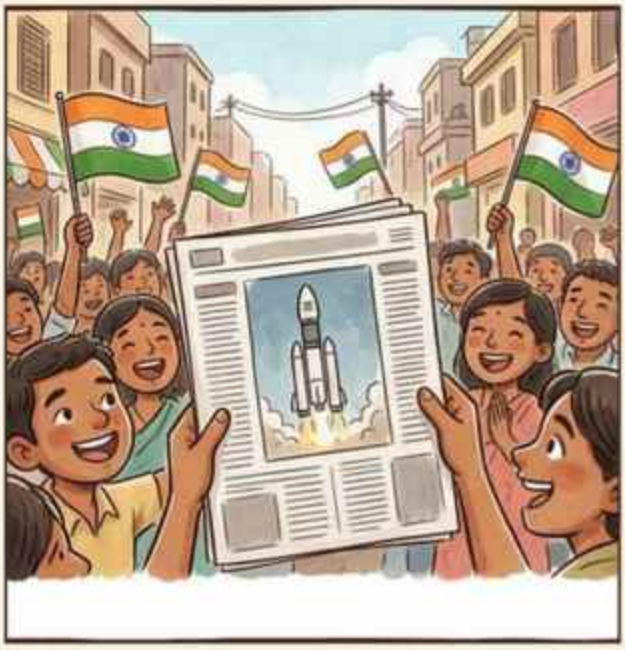


India became the seventh country to show independent satellite-launch capability.

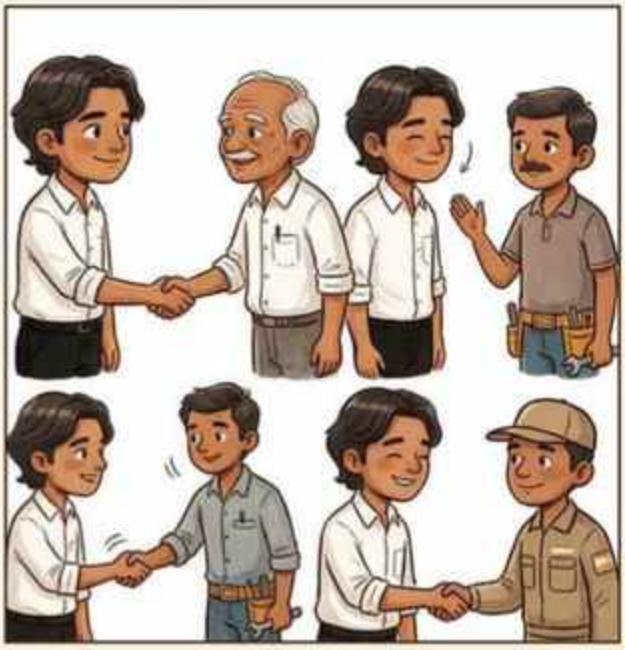


It was a historic achievement for Indian science!
Kalam: "We did it!"

A DREAM BECOMES REALITY

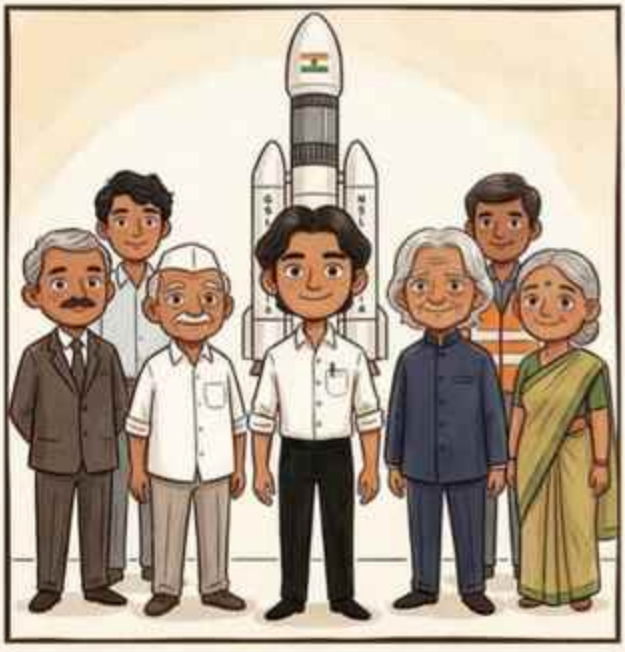


The SLV-3 success proved Indian scientists could build launch vehicles on their own.



Kalam thanked everyone who had worked tirelessly.

Kalam: "This victory belongs to all of you!"

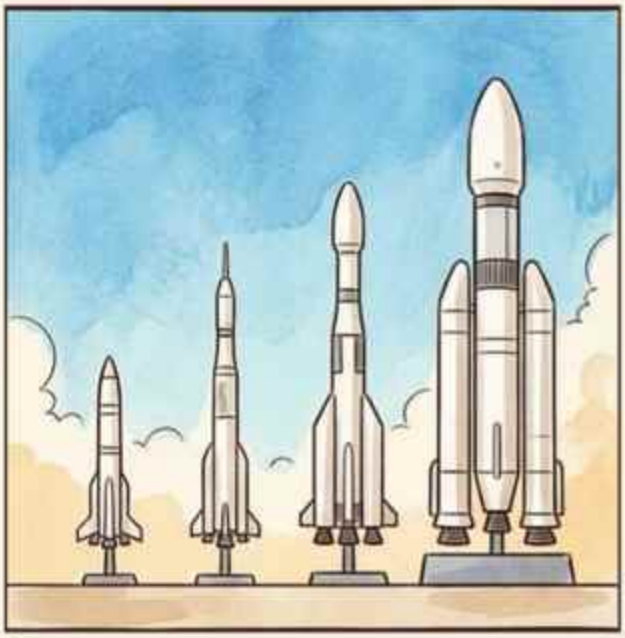


It was a true team achievement.



It inspired future generations of Indian space researchers.

A FOUNDATION FOR FUTURE MISSIONS



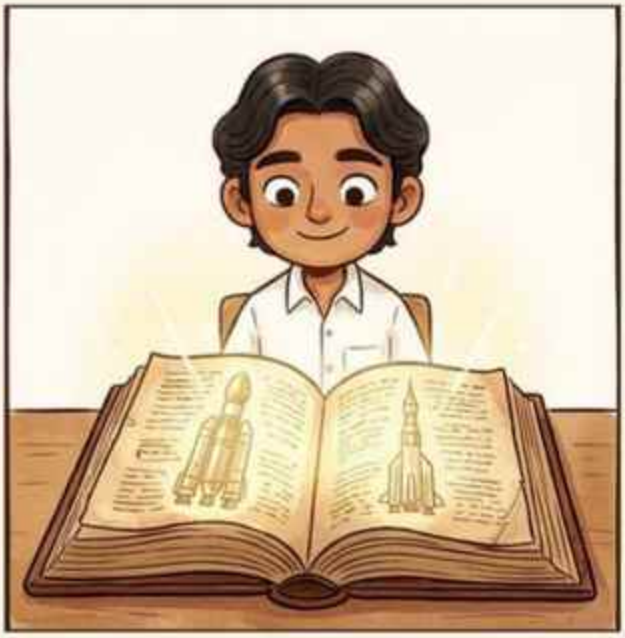
The knowledge from SLV-3 helped build India's future launch vehicles.



It strengthened India's own rocket technology.



It laid a foundation for more advanced space missions.



Kalam's work became an important chapter in ISRO's history.

A NEW NATIONAL RESPONSIBILITY



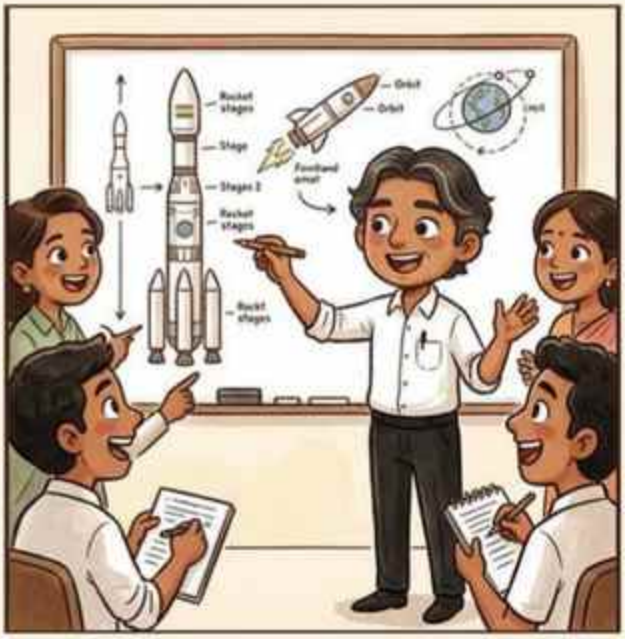
In 1982, Kalam returned to DRDO.



He took a leadership role at the Defence Research and Development Laboratory in Hyderabad.



He was given the responsibility of strengthening India's own defence technology.



He brought his ISRO experience to this new mission.

Kalam: "Let's learn from our space journey!"

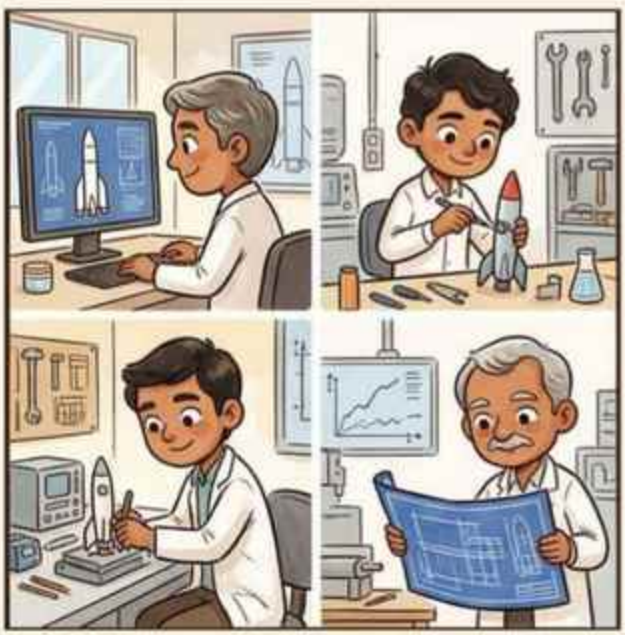
THE MISSILE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME



In 1983, India started the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme.



Kalam played a leading role in it.



The aim was to develop India's own guided missile technology.



Scientists began work on several important systems.

Team: "Jai Hind!"

DEVELOPING AGNI AND PRITHVI



Kalam guided teams working on missile projects, including Agni and Prithvi.



Prithvi was a surface-to-surface missile.



Agni became an important part of India's strategic programme.



These developments strengthened India's own defence capabilities.

A NATION'S PRIDE



His work in aerospace and missile technology made him famous.

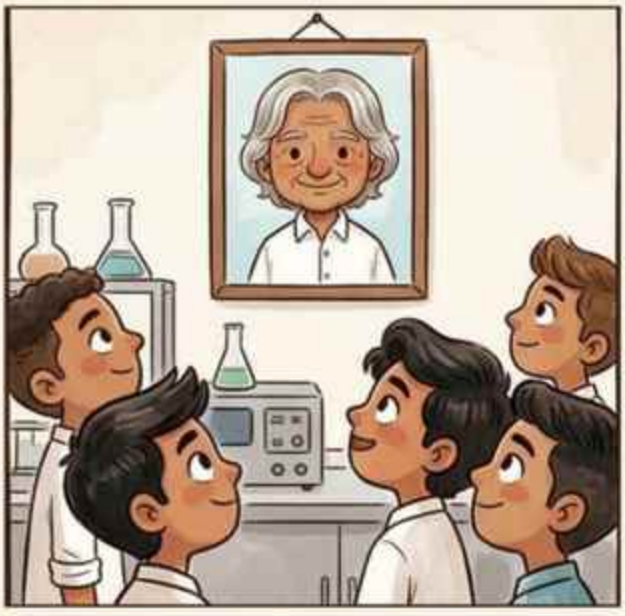


People: "The Missile Man of India!"



He believed science should make the country strong and self-reliant.

Kalam: "Knowledge makes a nation strong."



His achievements inspired thousands of young engineers.

A HISTORIC SCIENTIFIC MISSION



In May 1998, India conducted the Pokhran-II tests in Rajasthan.



Kalam was one of the key scientific leaders.



He worked alongside other scientists, including R. Chidambaram.



It was an important moment in India's scientific and strategic history.

NATIONAL RECOGNITION



Kalam received the Padma Bhushan in 1981,



the Padma Vibhushan in 1990...



...and the Bharat Ratna in 1997, India's highest civilian honour.



He became one of India's most respected personalities.

Kalam: "This honour belongs to my team and my teachers."

A SCIENTIST BECOMES PRESIDENT



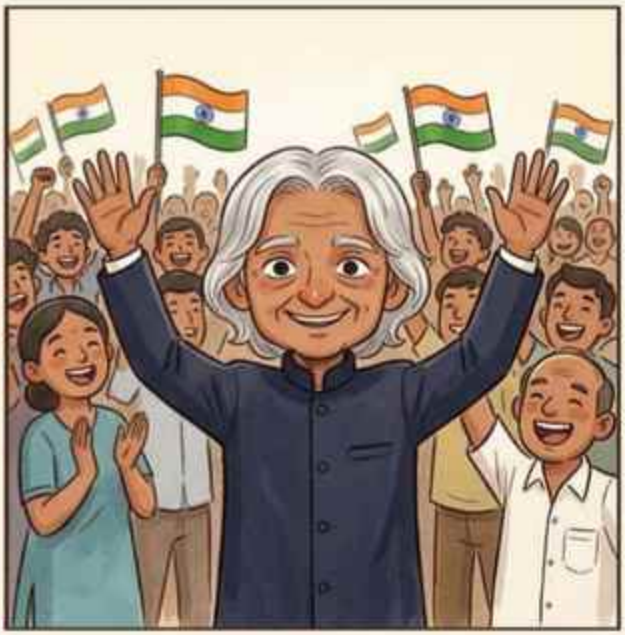
In 2002, Kalam was elected the 11th President of India.



On 25 July 2002, he took the oath of office.



A boy from a small coastal town...

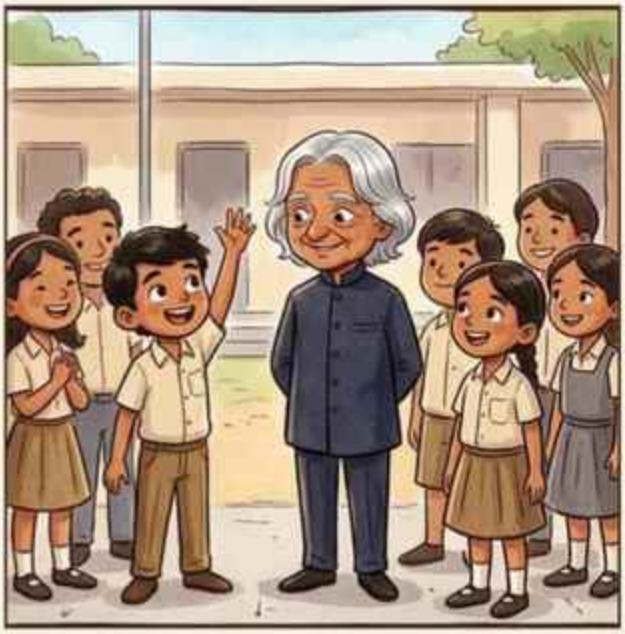


...had reached the highest constitutional position through education and hard work.

THE PEOPLE'S PRESIDENT



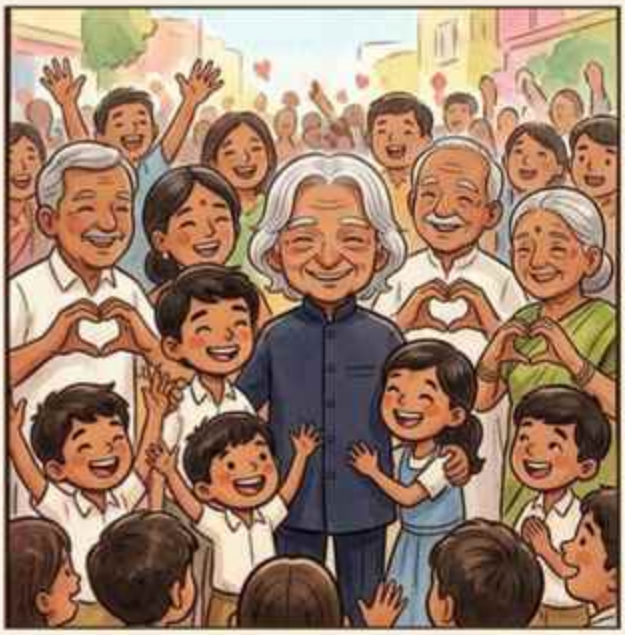
Kalam was known for his simplicity and humility.



He loved meeting students, teachers and young innovators.
Student: "Sir, how can I become a scientist?"

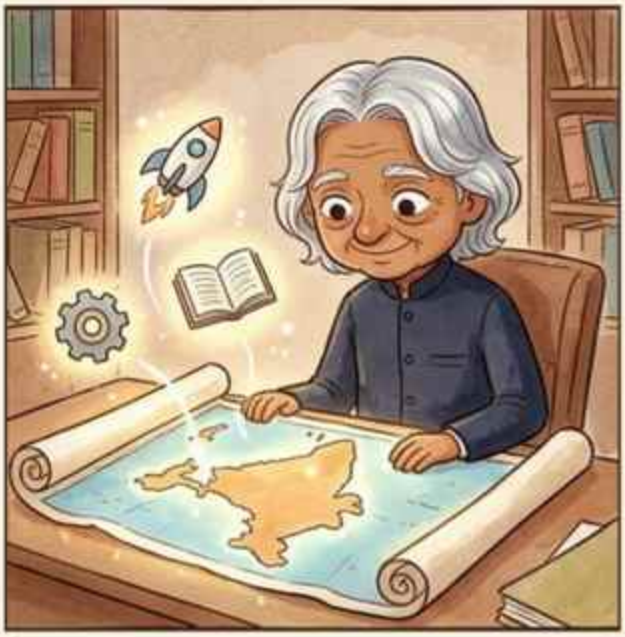


Kalam: "Dream big and never stop learning!"



People lovingly called him the "People's President".

INDIA 2020



Kalam dreamed of making India a developed nation.



His Vision 2020 promoted research, technology, agriculture and healthcare,



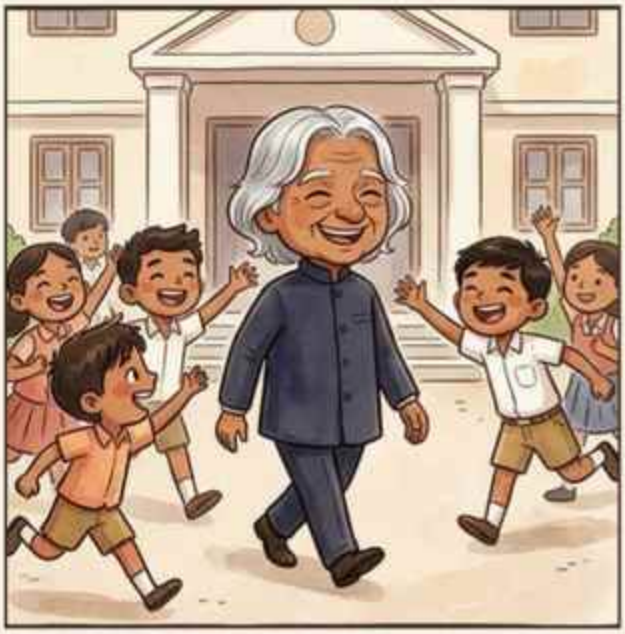
education and rural development.



He believed progress needed innovation and collective effort.

Kalam: "Together, we can!"

INSPIRING YOUNG MINDS



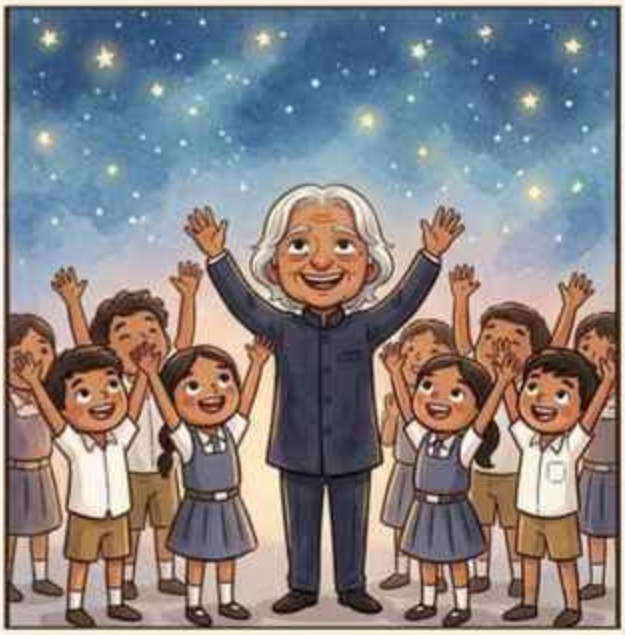
Kalam often visited schools and universities.



He encouraged children to ask questions and explore science.
Kalam: "Never stop asking why!"

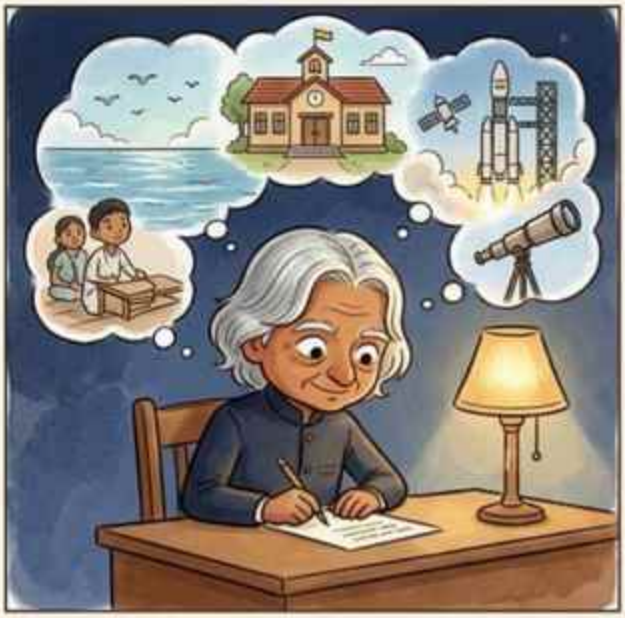


He loved their new ideas.



He believed young people were the nation's greatest strength.

WINGS OF FIRE



Kalam shared his life story in his autobiography, Wings of Fire.



It was co-written with Arun Tiwari and published in 1999.

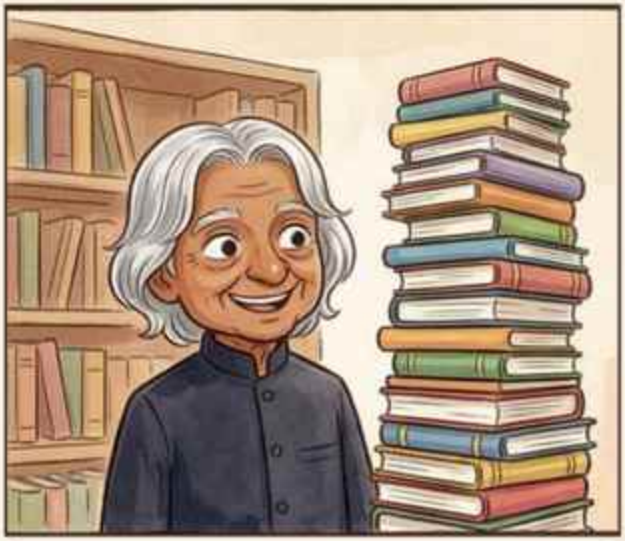


The book described his childhood, education, struggles and scientific career.



It inspired millions of readers to chase their dreams.

BOOKS THAT INSPIRED GENERATIONS



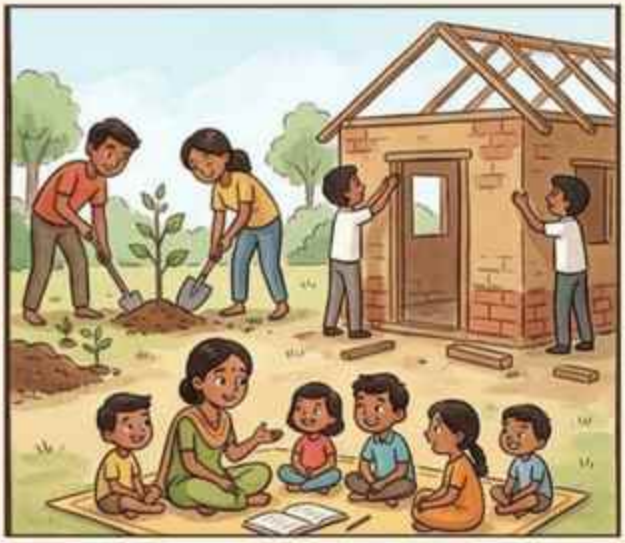
Kalam wrote several inspiring books...



...including Ignited Minds, India 2020, My Journey and Turning Points.

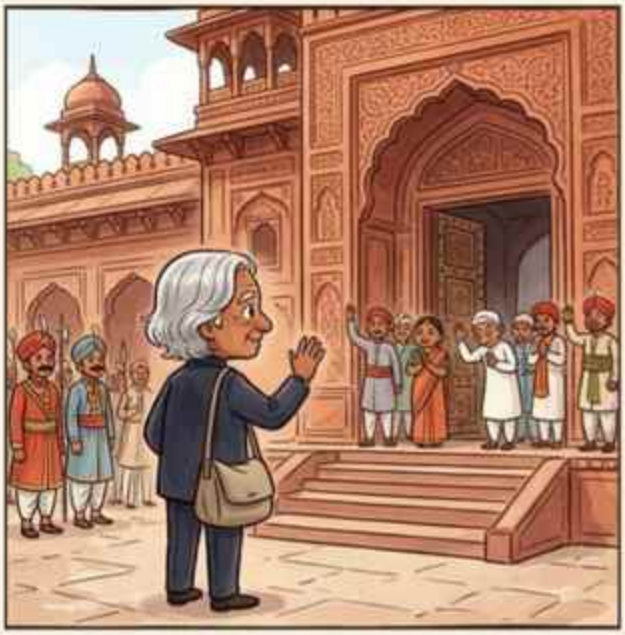


Through his writing, he encouraged students to think creatively...

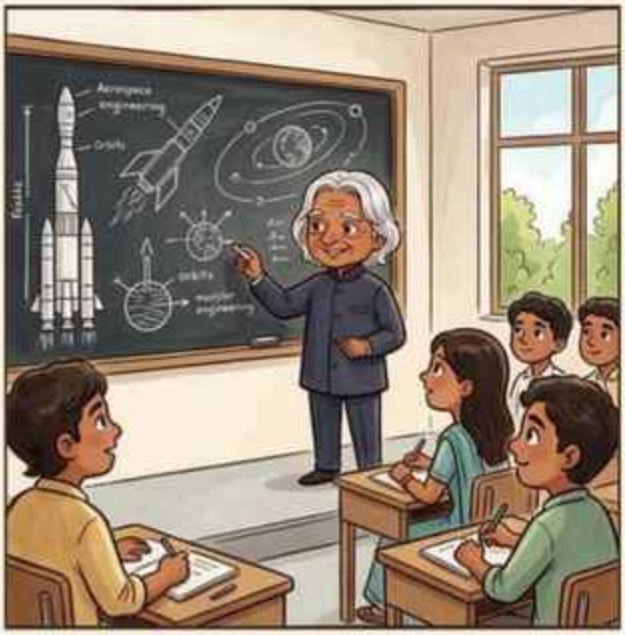


...work hard and contribute to society.

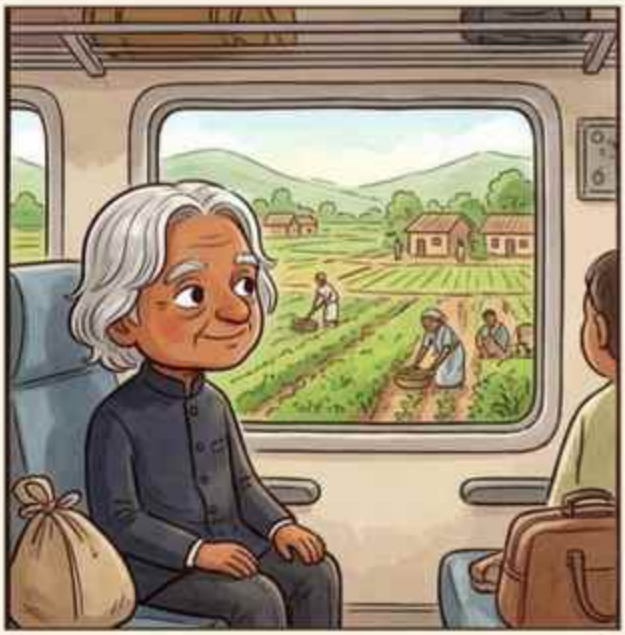
RETURNING TO TEACHING



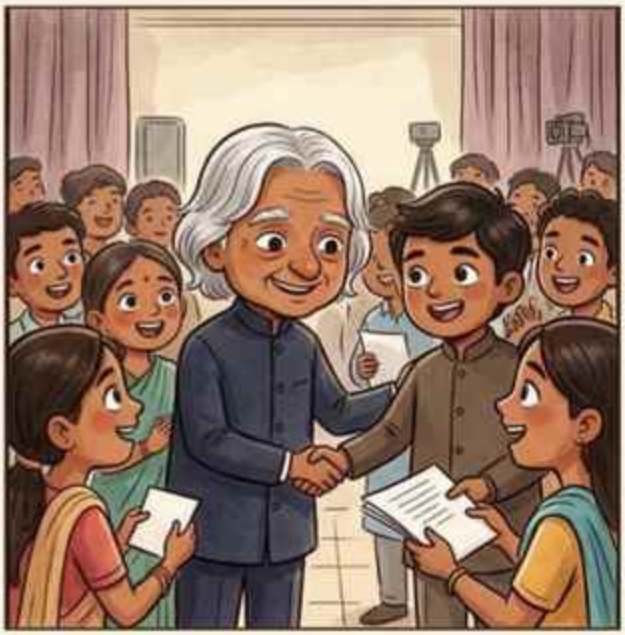
After completing his term in 2007, Kalam returned to teaching.



He visited universities, research institutions and schools across India.



He travelled all over the country.



He kept sharing knowledge and motivating students.

Kalam: "Find your purpose and pursue it!"

A DREAM FOR EVERY STUDENT



Kalam encouraged young innovators to solve real-world problems.



He promoted research, environmental protection...



...rural development and national unity.



He believed education could change lives and transform a nation.

Kalam: "Education is the key!"

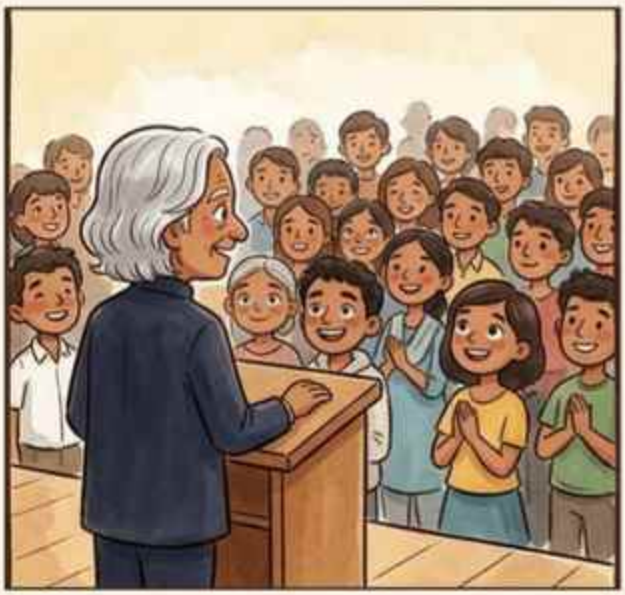
A TEACHER UNTIL THE END



On 27 July 2015, Kalam travelled to IIM Shillong.



He was there to deliver a lecture titled "Creating a Livable Planet Earth."



Even at 83, he was excited to meet students.



Kalam: "Let us make our planet a better home!"

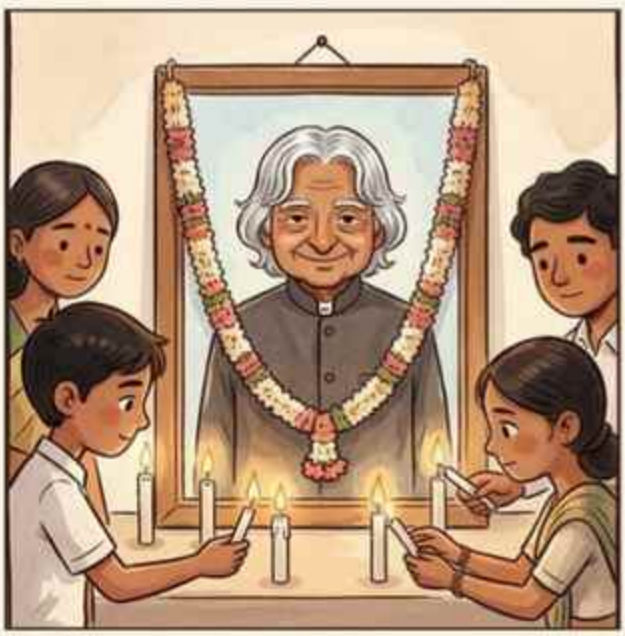
THE NATION MOURNS



While delivering his lecture, Kalam suddenly collapsed and was taken to hospital, where he passed away that evening.



The news shocked the entire country.



Students, scientists, leaders and citizens mourned...



...the loss of a great scientist and teacher.

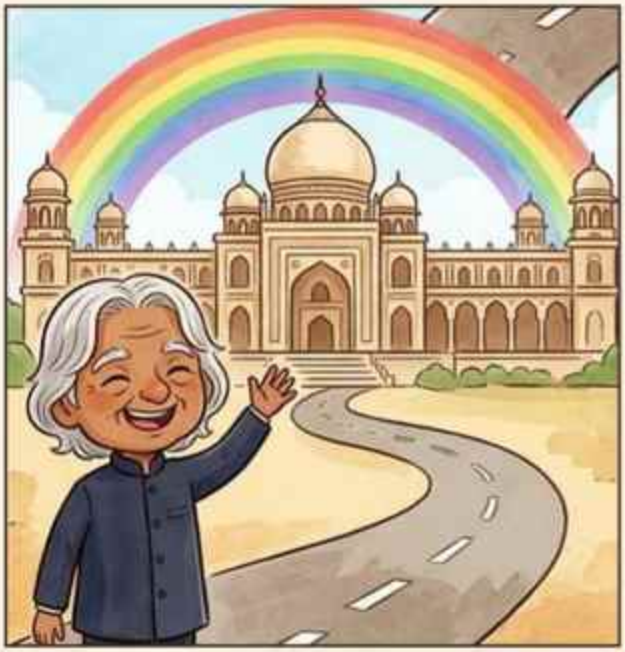
A LEGACY BEYOND ACHIEVEMENTS



From a newspaper-selling boy in Rameswaram...



...to an internationally respected scientist...



...and President of India, his story is one of determination and courage.

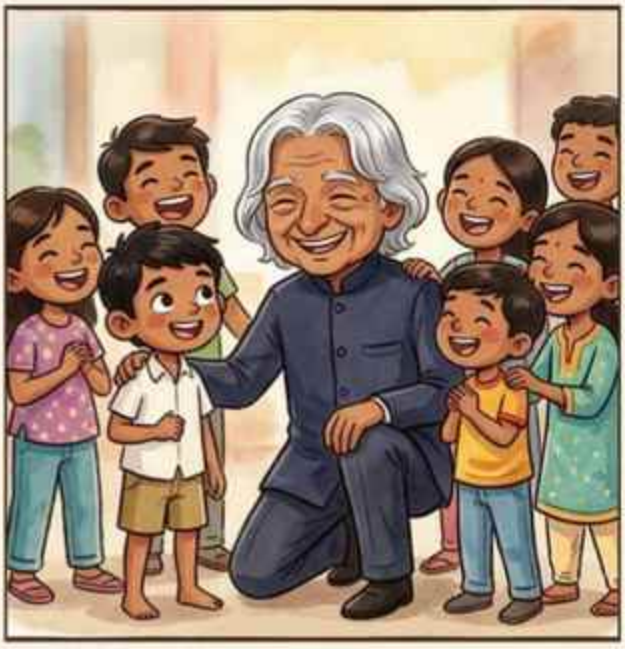


His work in space, technology, education and nation-building still inspires millions.

THE WINGS OF FIRE LIVE ON



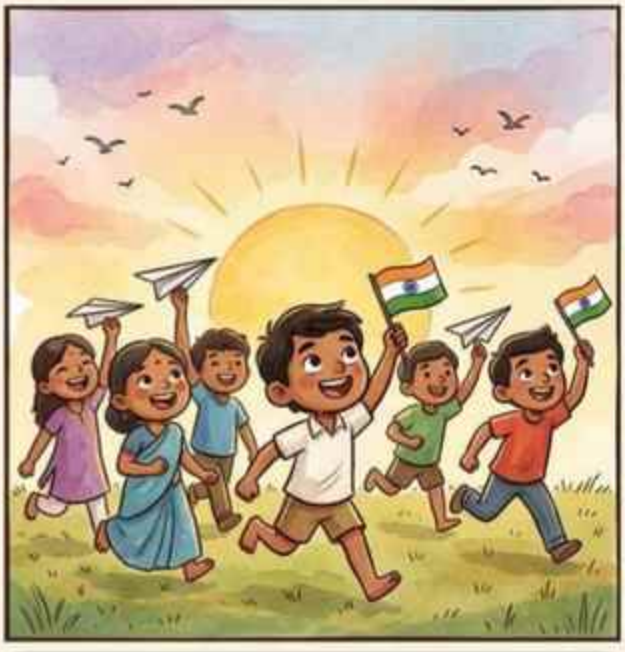
Today, he is remembered as the Missile Man of India,



the People's President and a great teacher.



His life teaches us to dream big, accept failures...



...work together and serve our nation.

INSPIRATION: "Dream, dream, dream. Dreams transform into thoughts and thoughts result in action." — Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam (1931–2015)

THE END

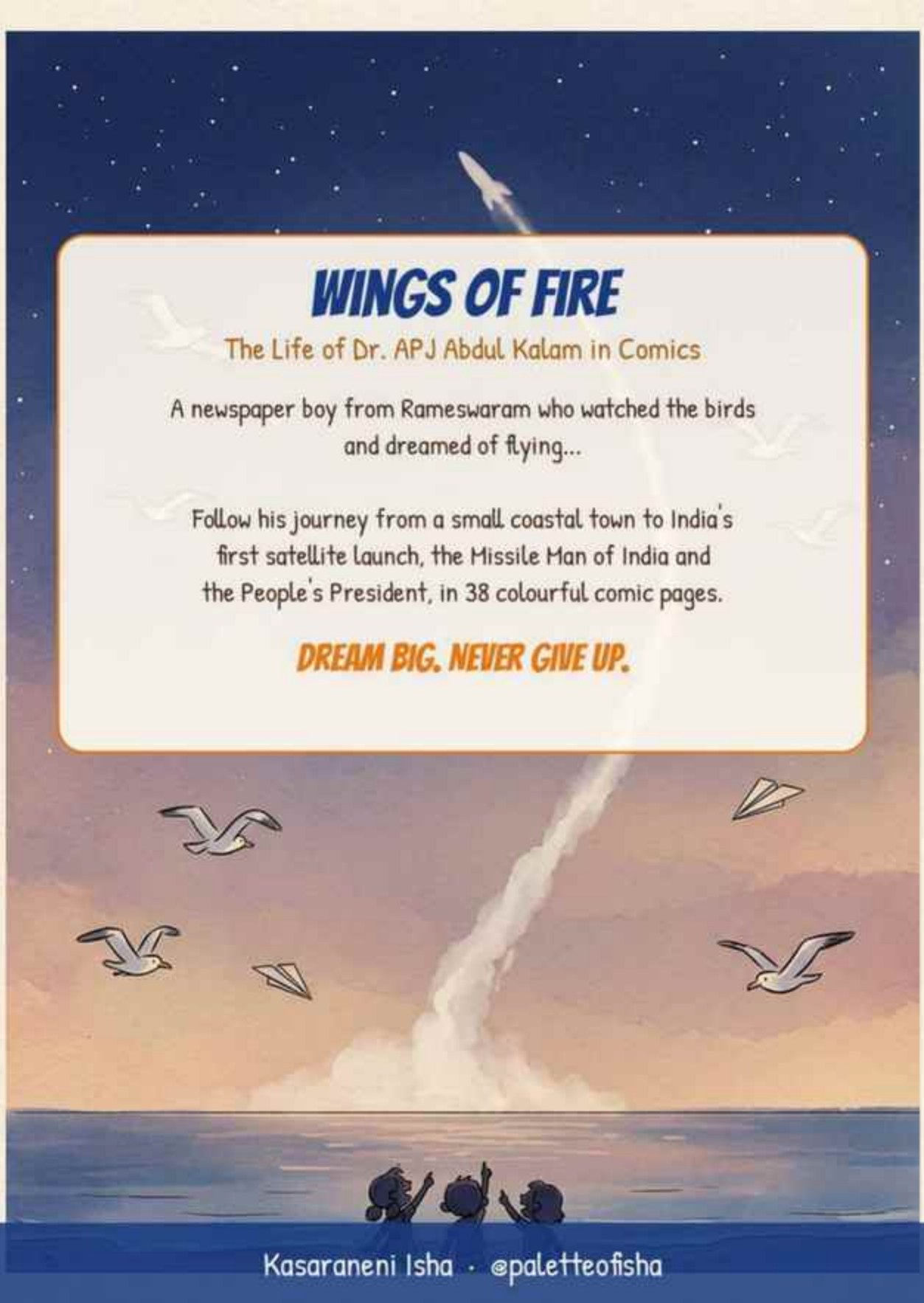
WINGS OF FIRE

The Life of Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam in Comics

A newspaper boy from Rameswaram who watched the birds and dreamed of flying...

Follow his journey from a small coastal town to India's first satellite launch, the Missile Man of India and the People's President, in 38 colourful comic pages.

DREAM BIG. NEVER GIVE UP.



Kasaraneni Isha · @paletteofisha